Table 49. Planning assumptions for the indicative budget

Item	Assumption	Basis
Exchange rate	Tk 124 per US dollar	Bangladesh Bank weighted average rate of Tk 123.65 on 19 October 2026 [79]
Core staff	9, 15 and 19 full-time equivalents in Years 1, 2 and 3	Staffing plan (Table 16)
Year 1 recruitment	75% of Year 1 positions filled on average	Director appointed in months 1 to 3; other posts filled in months 2 to 6 (Section 15.4)
Staff cost	Fully loaded monthly cost per FTE at Year 1 prices: Director Tk 3.0 lakh; ML and Bangla NLP engineers Tk 2.0 lakh; security engineer Tk 1.8 lakh; policy, data and platform staff Tk 1.5 lakh; governance and UX staff Tk 1.25 lakh; coordinator Tk 0.9 lakh; training officers Tk 0.8 lakh	Above the basic pay of the Ninth National Pay Scale 2026 (Tk 20,000 to Tk 156,000 per month, approved by the Cabinet in August 2026) to compete for scarce AI skills [80]
Escalation	8% a year on taka costs in Years 2 and 3	Point-to-point inflation of 8.34% in September 2026, as reported [81]; the host's increment rules may differ
Language editors and fellows	Part-time editors Tk 12 to 14 lakh a year; 6, 10 and 12 fellows at Tk 40,000 a month (Year 1 prices)	Fellowship programme (Section 6.6)
Equipment	General-purpose servers USD 12,000 each; GPU inference servers (L40S class) USD 25,000 each; storage USD 6,000 to 12,000 a year	Single L40S card about USD 7,500 and a four-GPU server about USD 47,000 to 49,000 in 2025 [82]
Import duty and VAT on equipment	Not included in the base case; 25% added in the high scenario	Depends on the host's exemption status; input required from the host's procurement office
Hosting and operations	Tk 25 lakh rising to Tk 38 lakh a year (Year 1 prices)	Data-centre space, power, bandwidth, licences and a development cloud
Model adaptation compute	In kind from shared national compute; USD 20,000 of cloud GPU time on public (P0) data in the high scenario	Table 31; draft national AI policy [10]; cloud prices in [82]
Benchmark and evaluation data	2,000 answerable questions by month 30 at Tk 2,500; 300 out-of-scope questions at Tk 600; 2,000 citation-support judgements at Tk 500	BanglaPolicyQA plan (Section 9.4); evaluation protocol (Annex R)
Training	500 officials by month 36 at Tk 15,000 per participant, plus specialist courses	Training curriculum (Table 18)
Evaluation and assurance	Legal review Tk 8 lakh; baseline study Tk 6 lakh; mid-term evaluation Tk 20 lakh; final evaluation Tk 25 lakh; annual penetration test and red team Tk 6 lakh; annual independent audit of systems Tk 3 lakh	Chapters 13, 14 and 18
Host overheads	10% of direct costs	To be confirmed against the host institution's policy
Contingency	5% of direct costs in the base case, released only by Steering Board decision; 10% recommended until quotations and the host's rates are known (adjusted base case and high scenario)	Allowance for estimating uncertainty; scenarios in Annex Q

Planning assumptions for the costing study (Deliverable D1.3), not quotations. The model is published as blueprint/src/budget_model.py so that any assumption can be changed and the budget regenerated.

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